FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-23-20001

Issue Title : Required Installation of a Global Aeronautical Distress and Safety System (GADSS) Autonomous Distress Tracking (ADT) System to the Airframe

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2324-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
767, 787, 777, 747	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/15/2020	05/28/2026	03/25/2026
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
12/31/2026	08/28/2026	

Revision Description

Updated the following sections: Description, Status, Interim Action.

Description

In accordance with the International Civil Aviation Orgainization (ICAO) Annex 6, Part 1, Appendix 9, new mandates are going into effect requiring airplanes with a Certificate of Airworthiness (COA) issued after 01 January 2024 to be equipped with a robust and automatic means to accurately determine, in flight, the location of airplanes in distress up to the point of end of flight. These new mandates include a standard for affected airplanes to be equipped with a system that autonomously transmits information at least once every minute from an airplane in distress for which a position can be determined by the operator. There is currently an allowance in effect by ICAO for those airplanes with a COA delivered after 01 January 2024 to continue operation until a retrofit installation of a distress tracking system can be completed no later than 01 January 2025. However, global regulators are allowing time-limited exemptions (TLE) for airplanes operating after 01 January 2025 that do not have a GADSS and have fixed emergency locator transmitters installed, allowing additional time for GADSS availability and installation.

The European Aviation Safety Agency (EASA), via Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2019/1384 of 24 July 2019, along with other global regulators (see attachment: Enclosures A), are mandating compliance to the ICAO standard by 01 January 2024 (with retrofit installation delay allowance to 01 January 2025 and TLE acceptance for operating in 2025 for airplanes with a fixed ELT).

The EASA mandate is also applicable to non-European Union (EU) commercial air operators, referred to as Third Country Operators (TCOs), as stated in Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) information for Operators (inFO 16018). For questions or comments regarding EASA-TCO authorizations, Boeing recommends contacting the International Programs and Policy Division (AFS-50) at +1 (202) 267-0962.

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EASA has released Notice of Proposed Amendment (NPA) 2020-03 with proposed changes to Certification Specification (CS), Acceptable Means of Compliance (AMC) and Guidance Material (GM) for Global Aeronautical Distress and Safety System - Autonomous Distress Tracking (GADSS-ADT).

Additionally, ICAO is working on proposed changes to Annex 6 and Procedures for Air Navigation Services – aircraft Operations (PANS-OPS) in order to provide additional guidance to states in implementing ADT. The current proposal (AN-WP/9361) is to amend Annex 6, Part I and PANS-OPS, Volume III, with an applicability date and schedule to allow time for states to incorporate the amendments into their state regulations and put in any necessary rules, and infrastructure in place, to implement those rules before the mandates take effect.

There are no ICAO standards or regulatory mandates for incorporation of a GADSS for airplanes with an COA prior to 01 January 2024.

Status

Boeing has developed solutions for all airplane models to support the new mandates for GADSS-Autonomous Distress Tracking (ADT), which will be available ahead of the TLE expiration dates. Suppliers (ACR Electronics and Dukane-Seacom) have been selected to provide the Emergency Locator Tracker-Distress Tracker (ELT-DT) portion of the GADSS-ADT. Boeing solutions include additional avionics functionality to support distress detection and triggering and an ADT transmitter unit ELT-DT to maximize commonality with the current Emergency Locator Transmitter Automatic Fixed (ELT-AF) installations. The Boeing GADSS-ADT solutions are used in place of the current ELT-AF units. Boeing is currently working to certify the GADSS-ADT with suppliers ACR Electronics and Dukane-Seacom.

Boeing has released the following Airplane Configuration Bulletins (ACB):

- 2021-ACB-0006-11, “Global Aeronautical Distress and Safety System - Autonomous Distress Tracking - New Options” was released on 13 August 2024, which discusses available GADSS-ADT options and implementations.
- 2024-ACB-0032-2, “Global Aeronautical Distress and Safety System - Autonomous Distress Tracking - Time-Limited Exemptions" was released on 20 December 2024, which discusses the availability of time-limited exemptions (TLE) and third-country operator (TCO) filing requirements for time-limited operations in 2025.
- 2025-ACB-0004-1, “Global Aeronautical Distress and Safety System - Autonomous Distress Tracking - Offerability Status”, was released on 15 May 2025, which informs customers about the current certification schedule for the global aeronautical distress and safety system - autonomous distress tracking (GADSS-ADT) for each model.

Boeing released Multi-Operator Message MOM-MOM-24-0470-01B, “Action - Local Regulatory Policies Needed on GADSS-ADT Mandated Regions Air Operations”, was released on 05 September 2024, which shows countries where their Civil Aviation Authority (CAA) has adopted the ICAO Annex,6, Part 1, Section 6.18.1 standard.

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Boeing has released Maintenance Tip 737-MT-23-008, “Preventing Global Aeronautical Distress and Safety System Nuisance Activations”, informing operators of additional maintenance conditions which may result in ELT-DT activation when compared to a Fixed ELT. For example, a loss of airplane power will trigger GADSS but would not trigger a Fixed ELT.

Interim Action

Boeing encourages airlines to work with their regulators and Boeing to help ensure the situation is well understood when considering ICAO standards for GADSS mandates and implementation timing so as to ensure a smooth retrofit for their affected airplanes within the TLE allowed time-frame. Operators are also encouraged to reach out to their International Air Transport Association (IATA) representatives to further discuss the implications of GADSS operations.

Discuss GADSS ADT readiness & mandate requirements and timing with your local regulator and communicate any concerns or updates with Boeing. Boeing is strongly recommending that operators request a Time-Limited Exemption (TLE) with their local regulators to allow continued operation in 2025 with a fixed ELT installed and to allow time to receive SB 737-23-1932 and incorporate it. The June 25, 2024, TLE Meeting discussed that operators may submit known TLE forms to Boeing and we would be happy to complete the technical portions of the form. These can be submitted through the Boeing Communication System (BCS) or through your Customer Engineering Account Manager.

For your convenience, all previous GADSS customer interface meetings etc. are posted on the Fleet IdeaXchange (FIX) calendar (https://fix.web.boeing.com/fix/viewmeeting/20068).

Review Boeing Airplane Configuration Bulletins (ACB) 2021-ACB-0006-11, 2024-ACB-0032-3, 2025-ACB-0004-1 and discuss any questions and concerns with Boeing.

Review attached Enclosures A, B, and C for affected countries and global regulatory agency requirements.

Review Boeing Maintenance Tip 737 MT 23-008 to avoid nuisance activation.

Operators should select either ACR Electronics or Dukane-Seacom for the ELT-DT (Dukane-Seacom availability is currently to be determined (TBD)). Dukane-Seacom is currently implementing hardware and software changes for their GADSS-ADT equipment. The estimated Technical Standard Orders (TSO) approval date for Dukane-Seacom is now projected for the 3Q 2025, but this is subject to change. Following TSO approval, Boeing will need to conduct additional certification activities, including Certification Flight Tests on all models, and then work towards a smooth implementation into our production system across three sites. As a result, Boeing is limiting the selection of the Dukane-Seacom product across models until a confident certification schedule can be established; the target availability is no earlier than mid-2026.

Review Boeing Service Bulletin: SB 737-23-1932. SB retrofit actions include replacing the current fixed ELT with an ELT-DT, replacing the ELT antenna, installing the Trigger Unit, replacing the ELT Control Panel, and implementing minor wiring changes. Following the hardware retrofit portion, the ELT-DT may require a minor software update to configure it for the specific airplane identification (airplane ID).

Boeing strongly encourages operators to develop schedules and planning to ensure their affected airplanes have completed a GADSS retrofit before Time-Limited Exemptions (TLE) expire to avoid any service interruptions.

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Final Action

Airplane post-Boeing delivery retrofit to install a GADDS ADT system before Time-Limited Exemptions (TLE) expire.

Milestones

Note: The target dates are based upon current certification schedule and do not constitute a commitment.

Solution Selected: November 2021 (Complete)

GADSS-ADT certification (with ACR Electronics): 2Q 2025 (Complete)

GADSS-ADT certification (with Dukane-Seacom): ECD Mid 2026 (Target)

Production Incorporation (with ACR Electronics): 2Q 2025 (Complete)

Service Bulletin Release (with ACR Electronics): 2Q 2025 (Complete)

Service Bulletin Parts Available: 2Q 2025 (Complete)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Other	CELEX_32019R1384_EN_YXT		04/09/2019
FAA Final Rule	FAA InFo 16018		10/03/2018
Airplane Configuration Bulletin (ACB)	2024-ACB-0032-2	2	12/31/2024
Airplane Configuration Bulletin (ACB)	2021-ACB-0006-11	2	08/13/2024
Airplane Configuration Bulletin (ACB)	2025-ACB-0004-1	1	05/15/2025
Multi-Operator Message (MOM)	MOM-MOM-24-0470-01B		
Maintenance Tip (MT)	737 MT 23-008		08/28/2025
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-23-1932	R01	10/27/2025
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-23-1938	R00	02/11/2025

Related Categories

- New Equipment : Information on new parts available now or soon to be introduced

Attachments:

a) Enclosures-B_MandateTleStatus

b) Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2019/1384

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c) FAA InFO 16018

d) Enclosures-C_TcoFilingRequirements

e) Enclosure-A_CountriesWithGadssRequirements

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